

Auto-Tech Nirvana!

A week of tech extravaganza, that's what I experienced at CES 2024, and boy was it one heck of a week! Before leaving for CES 2024, the invites for press conferences were all about AI, especially from the big tech companies. However, the big story at CES 2024 was about the auto tech boom. Cars are not just going electric, they are going tech-electric! Soon we will be bidding adieu to conventional dashboards, entertainment systems, and all things mechanical when it comes to cars!

Imagine a scenario where the usual dashboards, buttons, and mechanical parts step aside, giving room to expansive displays stretching seamlessly across the entire dashboard. Physical buttons are being swapped out for elegant touch interfaces, while an ever-growing array of cameras seamlessly integrates into our vehicles. This isn't merely a future vision; it's a reality swiftly approaching, catching up to us faster than we expected.

Auto Tech is the next big frontier for major tech companies, and the developments are nothing short of groundbreaking. Intel is leading the charge with its announcement of—the Intel SDV SoC designed specifically for electric vehicles. LG is contributing to the revolution with its impressive 57-inch Pillar-to-Pillar (P2P) LCD for cars, while Sony took the stage with its Afeela EV, featuring Unreal Engine 5.3 for graphics! Technology is steering our cars into the future, turning those cool sci-fi fantasies into reality.

What's propelling this revolution in auto tech is the shift toward electric cars. Electric vehicles (EVs) aren't only addressing concerns about how far they can go; they're also freeing up space inside vehicles for a surge of new technology. At CES 2024, Intel stepped up to reveal its SDV SoC designed for electric vehicles, offering a sneak peek into a future where cars transform into mobile computers. Imagine a central processing unit directing various vehicle features, much like the operating systems on our PCs. It's a dynamic platform, paving the way for in-car experiences we never imagined before.

However, this surge in auto tech isn't without its fair share of chaos. Major tech players like Intel, LG, and Sony are all aboard the auto tech bandwagon, unveiling their platforms and inte-



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grated solutions while forming partnerships with auto manufacturers. It's a competitive landscape, and as the dust settles over the years, a few winners will emerge with a clear roadmap for the future. Tech giants like Intel, Qualcomm, AMD, Nvidia, and others are engaged in a heated race to stand out with integrated solutions that will power the EVs of tomorrow. Despite the intricacy of the hardware processing and software layers, the implementation of imaging and display aspects is comparatively straightforward and modular. At CES 2024, Sony showcased its impressive imaging solutions for cars, including a 17.2MP 1/1.17 type sensor, claimed to be the industry's highest pixel count sensor in the automotive realm, Sony's Imaging division covers it all. Sony's sensors include front, back, and side cameras for a genuine 360-degree surrounding view, as well as depth sensing and long-range assist cameras for Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS) implementation. Additionally, in-cabin cameras are set to monitor driver attention on the road, track eye movement, and alert the driver in case they're in a sticky situation.

The real poster boys of the auto tech revolution are the touch-enabled displays. You'll not only see them and marvel at their capabilities, but you'll also interact with them for almost every feature in the car. The much-anticipated edge-to-edge display dashboard is poised to make its debut sooner rather than later. Already claiming close to 50% of the dashboard real estate, these displays are on the fast track to covering the remaining distance in no time!

Any yes, almost every single Auto Tech demo at CES 2024 did manage to squeeze AI into the conversation (just as I did the same here). Cause any new tech you launch today, you gotta ride the AI-Mania, it's almost become a part of the playbook. AI aside, what do you think of the future of cars and auto tech? Will EVs eventually take over and will tech features become the key considerations when it comes to buying a new car?

What's your take on tech in cars and the future of cars? Write to me at soham.raninga@digit.in, I'd love to hear your views

PS: I am an old-school driving enthusiast who craves free-revving engines and has a wide grin each time the turbo spools up! 



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